

Documents Pertaining to

an Altmer male, known in Skyrim as Fala

Compiled from Cyrodilic records, 4E 182–4E 201

Aldmeri Justiciary · Training Directorate · Private Correspondence · Imperial Court

Incident Assessment & Subject Profile

Ref: JO-CYR-4E182-0047 · Classification: Restricted

Subject: ██████████ of Skingrad, male, age 7

Reporting officer: Justiciar ██████████, 3rd Rank

Incident date: 14th of Sun's Dawn, 4E 182

Location: Skingrad, Colovia, Cyrodiil

The subject was involved in an altercation with a Nord male, age 8, which resulted in the death of the latter. I was present in proximity and intervened prior to the arrival of Imperial authorities. The incident was resolved without Imperial record. The Nord family was managed through standard channels.

What merits documentation is the nature of the act itself. The subject did not use a weapon. Death resulted from blunt force applied with an intensity inconsistent with a child of his age and build. Witnesses present — two other children — were too young to give coherent accounts and were easily dismissed.

More relevant is the subject's demeanour following the incident. No distress. No flight response. He stood over the body and appeared, by my assessment, to be waiting. Not for rescue. For something else. I cannot account for what.

I have spoken with the parents. They believe their son was present but uninvolved. I see no reason to correct this understanding at this time.

My recommendation is that this subject be noted for future evaluation. The capacity demonstrated — however uncontrolled — and the apparent absence of conventional fear response, marks him as a candidate of potential interest. I will make contact with the family at an appropriate interval.

Sealed under authority of the Aldmeri Justiciary, Cyrodiil Division · Not for Imperial circulation

Agent Candidate Progress Assessments — Selected Entries

Subject file: [REDACTED] · Years 4E 193–4E 196

Entry — 3rd of Hearthfire, 4E 193

First month of formal instruction. Aptitude for destruction magic is exceptional, particularly for his age. Absorbs theory rapidly and demonstrates instinctive application. One-handed form is rougher — he resists correction on grip, insisting his own method feels more natural. It may prove him right in time, though the attitude is noted. Restoration shows promise, which is unexpected. He appears to understand intuitively that mending and unmaking are not opposites.

Entry — 17th of Rain's Hand, 4E 194

A difficult quarter. The subject continues to perform at a high level technically but refuses the structure of collective exercises. He does not collaborate. In simulations requiring coordinated action he consistently acts independently, usually to the detriment of the exercise outcome and usually to his personal advantage within it. When confronted he does not argue. He simply looks at you. I find the look difficult to describe in a report. My superior tells me I am being imprecise. I am not being imprecise.

Entry — 2nd of Evening Star, 4E 195

Incident involving a senior candidate during sparring. The subject was corrected for an illegal strike. He completed the correction, then repeated the strike. When I intervened directly he stopped immediately and apologised without affect. There was no anger in him, which was in some ways worse. Recommend review of placement.

Entry — 9th of Midyear, 4E 196

Final assessment prior to separation. The subject's abilities are not in question. His suitability for operational work within a structured directorate is. He cannot be directed. He does not follow orders he has not already decided to follow. He is not defiant in the conventional sense — he does not rebel, does not argue, does not escalate. He simply does not subordinate. I have trained two dozen candidates. I have not encountered this before. He is being released from the programme. I expect this will not be the last record written about him.

Letter — Aranwe of Skingrad to her sister Miravel

Approx. 4E 196 · Recovered copy

Miravel,

He is back. I am sure you have already heard from mother, but I thought it better you hear it from me plainly. The arrangement with the Directorate has ended. The details were not given to us and I did not press for them. Caranir does not discuss it. Neither does our son.

He is well, physically. He looks older than he should. He has taken a desk in the office and manages the correspondence filing without being asked, which I did not expect. He is quiet. He has always been quiet but this is a different kind.

Caranir says we should be grateful he has come back with skills. I think Caranir is telling himself what is easiest to believe. Our son sat at dinner last night and I watched him the whole meal and I am not sure he was entirely with us. I do not know how to say this better than that.

He is useful to the practice. He has a good memory and clients find him composed, which they mistake for warmth. It is not warmth. But it serves.

I am not unhappy he is home. I want to be clear about that. I am saying only that I do not entirely know what has come home.

Write when you can.

— A.

Criminal Proceeding — Record of Charge & Sentence

Case ref: SKG-4E199-CR-014 · Presiding: Magistrate Drusus Helvian

Defendant: ██████████, Altmer male, age approx. 24

Victim: Edric Nullen, Breton male, age 41, resident of Skingrad

Date of incident: 3rd of Last Seed, 4E 199

Location: ██████████ Legal Office, Skingrad

Charge: Murder, first degree

The defendant did, on the aforementioned date, cause the death of Edric Nullen on the premises of his family's legal practice. The victim, known to local authorities as a habitual drunkard with a record of disorderly conduct, entered the premises in an agitated state and engaged in a verbal altercation with staff. The defendant was present.

Witness testimony confirms the defendant struck the victim multiple times. The victim did not survive. The defendant did not flee the scene and was found seated when Imperial Watch arrived. He offered no statement.

The court notes that the victim was a man of poor character and that provocation was likely. The court further notes that provocation does not constitute legal defence for the act committed. The nature of the injuries sustained by the victim is not consistent with proportionate response.

The defendant offered no statement at sentencing and showed no response to proceedings.

Sentence: Five years imprisonment, Imperial Correctional Facility, Skingrad

Eligible for release: 4E 204 — commuted to 4E 201 for conduct

Letter — Aranwe of Skingrad to her sister Miravel

Approx. 4E 201 · Recovered copy

Miravel,

I am going to tell you what happened and I need you to read it all the way through before you write back. I know what you will want to say. I am asking you not to say it until you have heard it from me properly.

He came to the door nine days ago. I had known, in the way you know these things, that he would be released before the five years were out — he was always too composed for prison to trouble him for long — and Caranir had said nothing about it, which meant Caranir had been thinking about it the same as I had. We had simply not spoken of it. It is easier, with Caranir, not to speak of things.

He looked well enough. Thinner. He had almost nothing with him — a pack, travelling clothes, a belt knife. He stood at the door and looked at me and did not say anything, in that way he has always had of waiting for you to go first.

I told him he could not come in.

I had decided this. I want you to understand that I had made the decision beforehand, that it was not a thing that happened to me in the moment. The practice has clients who know the name. There is the matter of what the neighbours understood about why one of us was away for two years. There is Caranir's standing with the guild. There are reasons, Miravel, good ones, and I had thought them through.

He looked at me for a moment. He pressed his lips together — just that, just the once — and then his face settled back into whatever it is his face does when he has decided not to feel something in front of you. He said he understood. He did not argue. He did not ask me to reconsider. I had prepared for him to ask me to reconsider and he did not.

Then Caranir appeared at my shoulder. I had not heard him come to the door. He did not say anything to me. He looked at our son for a moment and then he went back inside and came back with the old sword — you remember it, the one from the Septim campaign that has been in the chest under the stairs since before either of the boys were born. He held it out. Our son took it. Caranir said: good luck, then. And came back inside.

I closed the door.

I am telling you because you will hear it eventually and I would rather you heard it plainly. I am also telling you because I have told it to myself a number of times now and I find it becomes no easier to hold, and I thought perhaps setting it down would help. It has not helped.

Tell me I did the right thing. Tell me it was necessary. You are the only person I can ask.

Write soon.

— A.

Imperial Province of Cyrodiil — City of Skingrad
Office of the Magistrate

WRIT OF FREE PASSAGE

Form MC-7 · Provincial Travel Document

Ref: SKG-4E201-WP-0031 · **Issued:** 9th of Rain's Hand, 4E 201

Issuing authority: Magistrate Drusus Helvian, City of Skingrad, Colovia

BEARER DETAILS

Name: [REDACTED], known as Fala

Race: Altmer (High Elf)

Sex: Male

Age: Approximately 26

Distinguishing features: Pale Golden eyes, scarring on left side of jaw

TERMS OF PASSAGE

The bearer of this document is hereby granted lawful freedom of movement within the Imperial Province of Cyrodiil and across its provincial borders, including passage into the holds of Skyrim via the established roads of the Pale Pass and the Jerall crossing.

This writ is issued in accordance with standard release conditions and confers no special privilege beyond that of an ordinary Imperial subject travelling in good standing. It does not constitute endorsement of the bearer's character by this office.

This document is valid for one year from the date of issue and must be presented upon request to any officer of the Imperial Watch, Legion checkpoint, or border authority.

REMARKS

None.

Signed under the authority of Magistrate Drusus Helvian · Skingrad, Colovia · 4E 201

Personal Correspondence

Early Accounts

Whiterun, 4E 201

From the personal journal of Kodlak Whitemane, Harbinger of the Companions
& the records of Danica Pure-Spring, Priestess of the Temple of Kynareth, Whiterun

A New Recruit

Excerpted. Date of entry approx. early 4E 201.

We came upon a giant on the southern road — a routine enough thing, and the shield-siblings handled it as they always do. What I did not expect was the Altmer.

He was on the road alone. No horse, no cart, travelling light in the way of someone who either has nothing or has learned to carry nothing. He saw the giant and did not hesitate. Did not call out to us, did not wait to see how we fared. He simply moved toward it and engaged, and he fought well — controlled, efficient, a blade in one hand and fire in the other. He has had real training. You can see the shape of it even when a man fights outside the form he was taught.

When it was done he said very little. The shield-siblings were watching him the way you watch something you cannot quite place. Vilkas looked at me. I looked at the Altmer. He was cleaning his blade and paying us no particular attention, which I found more interesting than if he had tried to impress us.

I told him there was a place for him at Jorrvaskr if he wanted it. He considered this for a moment in the manner of a man deciding whether to accept a second cup of wine. Then he said he would come.

He calls himself Fala. I did not ask more than that. A man's name in Skyrim is his own business, and the ones who arrive with simple names and no history are often the most interesting in time. I have been wrong before. I do not think I am wrong this time.

There is something unusual about him. I cannot put it precisely. He is not unfriendly — he spoke to the others well enough — but he is not quite present in the way most men are. As though some part of him is attending to something the rest of us cannot hear. I have seen that look before, but rarely, and not in contexts I can easily explain.

He will be useful. Whether he will be anything more than that remains to be seen.

An Account of Unusual Circumstances

Written the morning of the second day. Date of event approx. early 4E 201.

I am writing this now, while it is still fresh, because I find I need to set it down somewhere outside my own head.

He was brought in before midnight by one of the Jorrvaskr maids — Lenna, the older one — who had found him collapsed in his bunk. She said he had gone to sleep normally and that another shield-sibling had noticed him unresponsive some hours later. He was breathing, she said. He was warm. Too warm.

When they laid him on the cot I could see immediately that the fever was severe. His skin was dry and very hot in the way that precedes the worst outcomes, and he was entirely insensible — not sleeping, not unconscious in any way I recognised, but absent. Present in body and nowhere else. I have tended the dying and I have tended the merely ill and this was neither. I cannot explain it better than that.

I began with standard restoration. The fever did not respond. I tried again, adjusting my approach as I would for a patient with resistance or prior magical exposure. Nothing. I sat with this for a time and then worked through everything I know — every technique, every prayer, every application of Kynareth's blessing I have been taught and developed in twenty years of practice. The magic reached him. I could feel it making contact. It simply did not take.

It is difficult to describe what it felt like from my end. Imagine pressing your hand against a wall that gives slightly, as though it might yield, and then does not. There was something in him that the restoration could not find purchase on. Not a resistance, exactly. More like — I keep returning to this image — like trying to fill a vessel that is already full of something else entirely.

He did not worsen. I will say that. Through the entire night, as I worked and failed and worked again, he did not deteriorate. The fever held at its peak and did not climb. By the small hours I had stopped trying to break it and simply sat with him, which is the only honest thing left to do when you have run out of everything else.

He woke at dawn.

Not gradually, the way fever patients usually surface — confused, disoriented, asking for water. He simply opened his eyes. He looked at the ceiling for a moment. Then he sat up and looked at me and asked, in a perfectly ordinary tone, where his things were.

I told him he had been brought in during the night with a severe fever. He received this information the way you receive news about the weather. He thanked me for my time. He gathered his things from the chair where Lenna had left them, and he left.

I stood in the temple for some time after he had gone. I have been a priestess of Kynareth for most of my adult life. I believe in the work I do. I believe the goddess moves through me when I practice restoration, and I believe that belief is justified by twenty years of results.

Last night my results were nothing. And this morning a man with a fever that should have killed him walked out of my temple and asked where his things were.

I do not know what he is. I am not certain I want to.

Personal record of Danica Pure-Spring · Temple of Kynareth, Whiterun · Not for general circulation

The Journal of Lucien Flavius

Being a faithful account of travels undertaken across the province of Skyrim

Commenced at Falkreath, early 4E 201
Written in the hand of Lucien Flavius, scholar, Imperial City

First Entry

Dead Man's Drink, Falkreath. Morning. Early 4E 201.

I have a companion. This is a more significant development than it might sound, given that I have spent the better part of three days attempting to acquire one.

Falkreath was not supposed to take this long. My intention had been to pass through it quickly, hire someone sensible at the inn, and be on the road north before the week was out. What I had not accounted for was that mercenaries, as a professional class, are considerably more selective than their reputation suggests. Or perhaps it is simply that Skyrim mercenaries in particular have a highly developed instinct for when a proposition is going to involve more effort than the coin warrants, and something about me reads as effort.

I put my case to four men over the course of two days. The first heard me out politely and then remembered a prior engagement. The second did not hear me out at all. The third asked how much I was offering, laughed in a way I found difficult to interpret charitably, and went back to his drink. The fourth was actually quite interested until I mentioned that the work would involve significant travel on foot, at which point he also remembered a prior engagement.

I had begun, I will admit, to question the entire enterprise. The inn at Falkreath is called Dead Man's Drink, which I had initially found charmingly atmospheric and which by the third morning had begun to feel like a commentary on my prospects.

This morning I tried once more. There was a mercenary at the bar settling his tab as I came down — an Altmer, travelling alone from the look of him, armour that had seen better years and a pack already by the door. He had the look of someone passing through rather than staying, which meant if I was going to say anything I needed to say it quickly.

I called out. He stopped.

I gave him the same proposal I had given the others — the journey, the documentation, the need for a capable companion on the road. He listened without much visible interest. I had the distinct impression I was losing him in the same way I had lost the others, which was discouraging, so I mentioned the three hundred septims rather sooner than I had planned to.

That got his attention. He looked at me properly for the first time. He asked when we were leaving. I said this morning. He said he was in.

And that was more or less that. He gave his name as Fala — just the one name, offered without elaboration — and waited by the door while I gathered my things. He is not talkative. He ate the bread the innkeeper brought him very quickly in the manner of a man who was hungrier than he intended to let on, and then we left.

So. I am on the road in Skyrim at last, which is what I came here to do, and I have someone capable-looking walking slightly ahead of me, which is what I needed. Whether this arrangement will prove to be a good one I cannot yet say. He seems competent. He seems like

he would rather be moving than standing still. These are, I think, the most important qualities in a travelling companion and everything else can be established in time.

The road north from Falkreath is very beautiful, in the particular Skyrim way of being beautiful — which is to say large and cold and rather indifferent to whether you find it beautiful or not. The pines here are enormous. I had read about the forests of Falkreath Hold and I find the reality exceeds the description, which is not always the case.

More when there is more to report.

— *L.F.*

The personal journal of Lucien Flavius · Imperial City, Cyrodiil · Private record

Second Entry

Camp outside Windhelm, Eastmarch. Evening. Early 4E 201.

Several days on the road and I find I have not written, which is unlike me. In my defence there has been very little to report beyond the fact that Skyrim is extremely large and the wind here has a personal quality to it, as though it has identified you specifically and decided you deserve the full experience.

We have been camping each night. I had not anticipated quite this many consecutive nights outdoors and I will confess my bedroll, which seemed adequate in the Imperial City market where I purchased it, has proven to be a document of optimism rather than a practical piece of equipment. Fala appears unbothered by the cold, which I find irritating in the way that competence in areas where one is suffering tends to be irritating.

He is efficient in camp. That is the word I keep returning to. He does not make a production of anything — fire, shelter, watch — it simply gets done, quietly, without commentary. I have tried to be useful and have succeeded to a degree I would describe as partial. He has not commented on this either, which I appreciate.

Conversation remains sparse. I have learned that asking him direct questions produces the minimum viable answer and that the most I can hope for is the occasional observation offered without prompting, usually about the road ahead or the weather, delivered in the tone of a man reading aloud from a map. I am cataloguing these observations carefully as they are currently the most insight I have into how his mind works.

Today Windhelm appeared on the horizon and I felt, genuinely, a small surge of relief. A city. Walls, gates, presumably an inn with a fire and food that had not been cooked over wet wood. I had been thinking about it for the last few miles and I was already deciding between a hot meal and a bath when we reached the gates and Fala stopped.

He looked at the city for a moment. I waited for him to move toward the gates.

He turned off the road.

I asked where we were going. He said we would camp past the farms. I said we were standing outside a city. He said the camp would be better. I asked in what sense the camp would be better than a city with an inn in it. He said Windhelm was fine. I asked why, if Windhelm was fine, we were not going into it. He looked at me with the expression he uses when he considers a question settled and walked on.

So we are camped past the farms. The fire is good, I will grant him that. And the city is visible from here, its lights just distinguishable through the dark, which I find I am choosing not to look at directly.

He has been in Windhelm before. I am certain of it. Whatever happened there he is not going to tell me, and I have enough self-awareness to know that asking again will produce nothing except the expression. I have noted it and I am letting it alone.

Tomorrow we go northeast to clear a post for the Companions. I will write about that when it is done. Tonight I am going to attempt to get him talking, because we have a fire and nowhere to be and I have questions that are accumulating faster than he is answering them.

I will report on how that goes.

— *L.F.*

The personal journal of Lucien Flavius · Imperial City, Cyrodiil · Private record

Third Entry

Camp east of Windhelm, Eastmarch. Late night. Early 4E 201.

I am writing this by the last of the fire because I was told to go to sleep and I am not quite ready to go to sleep.

I got him talking. Partially. I want to record this accurately because I suspect opportunities like this one do not come along frequently and I would like an accurate record of what was actually said versus what I might later convince myself was said.

The snow had stopped by the time we had the fire going and the sky had cleared completely, which put me in a generous mood. I asked about his work with the Companions. He said they gave him fair enough work and paid him well enough. I asked what kind of work. He said someone always needed intimidating or a beast killing, it was always something like that. I wrote this down.

I asked what brought him to Skyrim. He went quiet. I have learned that his silences are not the silences of a man who has not heard you. They are the silences of a man who has heard you perfectly well and is deciding whether you deserve an answer. On this particular question I did not deserve one, and I moved on.

Then I asked about the eye.

I have been wanting to ask since Falkreath. It is a significant injury — the right eye, completely gone, scarring across the cheekbone — and I had been waiting for what felt like the correct moment. The correct moment had not presented itself in several days of travel, so I decided to manufacture one.

He said: sabre cat.

Just that. As though this were a complete and satisfying account of the matter. I pressed, and what emerged over the course of considerable effort was this: his first job for the Companions had been given to him by Aela the Huntress — and here he said, with what I am fairly certain was the driest humour I have ever encountered delivered with a completely straight face, that he reckoned she had wanted him dead, that she could not have an elf making the Companions look bad. The job was a sabre cat that had gotten into a house in Solitude, not far from the Blue Palace. He had gone to handle it with an iron sword and the clothes he had travelled in, having at that point no armour and apparently no funds to acquire any.

The cat had not stayed in the house. I asked if he had run from it. He said the encounter had moved to the street, which I take to mean yes. He said the whole city had more or less watched. The eye had happened inside, during the chaos, and it had not changed much about the fight because by that point there was only one thing left to do.

He killed it.

Then he walked back to Whiterun. In the clothes he had fought in. With a freshly ruined eye. On foot. I asked what Aela had said when he returned. He said nothing important. I asked if he had brought the pelt. He looked at me as though this were a strange question. Of course he had brought the pelt.

I asked if any of that had made him reconsider. He said they gave him a bed and food and that was better than your regular situation on the road. Then I asked where in Colovia he was from — he had let that slip — and he said Skingrad, just the one word, and then he said that was enough, that he was going to bed and I should too, big day tomorrow.

And that was the end of the conversation.

He is asleep now, or doing a convincing impression of it. The fire is almost out. In the morning we go northeast to the post.

Tonight I am thinking about a man walking back from Solitude with one eye and a cat pelt, and finding that sufficient.

— *L.F.*

The personal journal of Lucien Flavius · Imperial City, Cyrodiil · Private record